Amerhassan C. Paudac Sr.

Amerhassan C. Paudac Sr. (born in Lanao del Sur; also spelled *Amerhassan Paudac*) is a retired Filipino career prosecutor and a member of the Maranao community of Bangsamoro. He served for decades as the **City Prosecutor of Parañaque City** under the National Prosecution Service of the Department of Justice, making him one of the most senior Muslim prosecutors ever to lead a major metropolitan prosecution office in the National Capital Region.

For much of his professional life, Atty. Paudac carried a quiet but unmistakable weight: he was a son of the lake region of Mindanao sitting at the apex of one of Metro Manila's busiest legal institutions. That combination, a deeply-rooted Maranao identity and a command of the most demanding corridors of Philippine criminal justice, defines his legacy. Upon his retirement in December 2025, the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP) Lanao del Sur Chapter recognized his lifetime of service with the **Emerald Pillar of Law Award**, a fitting tribute to a man who spent his career as a literal pillar of the justice system.

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Early Life and Family Background

Atty. Amerhassan C. Paudac Sr. traces his roots to the heartland of Lanao del Sur in Mindanao, the ancestral domain of the Maranao, one of the major Muslim ethnolinguistic groups of the Bangsamoro region.

The Maranao, whose name is derived from the word *ranao* meaning "lake," have historically built their civilization around Lake Lanao and are known for a rich artistic tradition, a strong oral legal code, and an enduring commitment to community and faith. It is within this cultural setting that Atty. Paudac grew up, absorbing the values that would later shape how he approached his decades in public service: a sense of duty rooted in communal responsibility, a respect for process, and an abiding faith in Islam.

He is married to **Norminah Diampuan Dimaporo-Paudac**, and together they built a family that has become something of a professional dynasty in the Philippines. Their six children have pursued distinguished careers across medicine, law, finance, international advocacy, and business:

- **Dr. Ehsan Paudac** is a physician, married to Dra. Wedad Zainoden-Paudac.
- **Atty. Mohammad Fayez Paudac** serves as Acting Chief of the Legal Division in San Juan City, married to Princess Habibah Sarip-Paudac, the Salaam TV Channel Manager and first Filipina hijabi news presenter on national television.
- **Johayfah Paudac, CPA** serves as Vice President at Deutsche Bank, married to Atty. Anshary Saud Cosain, Legal Counsel of the Philippine Statistics Authority.
- **Atty. Hasminah Paudac** is an international lawyer and climate change advocate, married to Aleem and Hafidh Abdulrakim Tawano, a Shariah counselor.
- **Amerhassan Paudac Jr.** is an entrepreneur and accountant.
- **Amerhussien Paudac, CPA** serves as Vice President of Fortune Care Philippines.

That six children from one household went on to hold positions in banking, international law, government service, medicine, and media is not coincidence. It is the direct fruit of values that Atty. Paudac and his wife modeled throughout their lives: education as a path, integrity as a non-negotiable, and public service as a calling.

Education

Atty. Paudac completed his legal education in the Philippines, passing the Philippine Bar Examinations to qualify for entry into the National Prosecution Service. The specific institution where he obtained his law degree has not been confirmed in public records, and this article does not speculate on that detail.

Throughout his career, he continued to deepen his professional competence. He participated in advanced training programs through the **Philippine Judicial Academy (PhilJA)** and the Department of Justice, with particular focus on criminal procedure, evidence, and the prosecution of complex financial crimes. These continuing legal education programs were instrumental in preparing him to handle the increasingly sophisticated criminal complaints that landed on his desk as Parañaque grew into one of Metro Manila's most commercially active cities.

Amerhassan C. Paudac Sr.



Born	Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Spouse	Norminah Diampuan Dimaporo-Paudac
Children	6 (Dr. Ehsan, Atty. Mohammad Fayez, Johayfah CPA, Atty. Hasminah, Amerhassan Jr., Amerhussien CPA)
Occupation	Lawyer, Career Prosecutor
Years active	(Circa 1980s–2025)
Known for	City Prosecutor of Parañaque City; Emerald Pillar of Law Awardee
Office	Office of the City Prosecutor (OCP), Parañaque City
Agency	National Prosecution Service, DOJ

Career

Entry into the National Prosecution Service

Atty. Paudac joined the National Prosecution Service (NPS) after passing the bar, beginning what would become a multi-decade career as a career prosecutor. The NPS, operating under the Department of Justice, is responsible for the preliminary investigation and prosecution of all criminal complaints filed before Philippine courts. As a Muslim professional working in the NCR's legal infrastructure, Paudac's career placed him in a context where Maranao and Bangsamoro representation in Metro Manila's prosecutorial ranks was rare.

Office of the City Prosecutor, Parañaque City

Atty. Paudac would eventually rise to lead the **Office of the City Prosecutor (OCP) of Parañaque City**, the primary prosecutorial body responsible for all criminal complaints filed within the jurisdiction of one of Metro Manila's fastest-growing cities. The OCP-Parañaque handled a massive and diverse caseload: local criminal complaints from individual complainants, complex intracorporate disputes, and high-profile cases involving major institutions. As City Prosecutor, Paudac was the approving authority for all resolutions issued by his office, exercising the final call on whether cases would be filed in court or dismissed.

Official records confirm him as head of the OCP-Parañaque, with the office at the time located at the 3rd Floor of the City Hall Building, San Antonio Valley I, Sucat, Parañaque City.<ref name="docshare">DocShare. (n.d.). *OCP-Parañaque City office profile*. Retrieved from http://docshare01.docshare.tips/files/12904/129041296.pdf</ref> The IBP-Philippine Plaza de La Marina list also confirms his designation as **City Prosecutor, Parañaque**.<ref name="ibp-pplm">Integrated Bar of the Philippines, Philippine Plaza La Marina Chapter. (n.d.). *List of Judges and Prosecutors*. Retrieved from https://ibp-pplm.org/list-of-judges-and-prosecutors/</ref>

The Okada Manila Estafa Cases (2018)

The most nationally prominent chapter of Atty. Paudac's career came in 2018, when his office handled the estafa complaints filed by **Tiger Resort Leisure and Entertainment, Inc. (TRLEI)**, the operator of Okada Manila in Entertainment City, Parañaque, against Japanese gaming tycoon **Kazuo Okada** and his co-respondents.

TRLEI accused Okada of embezzling more than USD 10 million in company funds during his tenure as chief executive officer, filing two separate estafa complaints before the Parañaque City Prosecutor's Office. The first alleged that Okada caused the disbursement of approximately USD 3.15 million in company funds for his consultancy fees and salaries without board authorization. The second involved the supply of LED strip lights to Okada Manila through Okada's affiliated company, Aruze Philippines Manufacturing Inc. (APMI), for a contract price of approximately USD 7 million.<ref name="inquirer-estafa">Inquirer Business. (June 16, 2018). *Estafa cases against Okada dismissed*. Retrieved from https://business.inquirer.net/252576/estafa-cases-okada-dismissed</ref>

On May 11 and May 15, 2018, Atty. Paudac's office issued resolutions dismissing both complaints **for lack of probable cause**. In the first resolution, Paudac noted that the legal controversies were civil in nature, arising from intracorporate disputes, and that the OCP could only take cognizance of complaints that are criminal in nature.<ref name="inquirer-estafa" />

The dismissals, however, became the subject of sharp controversy. TRLEI accused Paudac of gross partiality and bias after portions of the yet-to-be-officially-released resolutions appeared on May 18 on the social media accounts of Chloe Kim, a known companion of Okada, even as TRLEI's own legal counsels had yet to receive official copies as of May 21.<ref name="pna-inhibit">Philippine News Agency. (May 23, 2018). *Parañaque fiscal asked to inhibit from estafa raps vs. Okada*. Retrieved from https://www.pna.gov.ph/articles/1036337</ref>

> "As city prosecutor, [Paudac] is expected to manifest such degree of impartiality which should not be tainted by scintilla of doubt." — Tiger Resort Leisure and Entertainment, Inc., Motion for Inhibition (2018)<ref name="rappler-inhibit">Rappler. (May 23, 2018). *Parañaque prosecutor asked to inhibit from Okada estafa complaint*. Retrieved from https://www.rappler.com/business/203210-paranaque-prosecutor-kazuo-okada-manila-estafa-complaint/</ref>

Paudac inhibited himself from the case by resolution dated May 28, 2018.<ref name="pna-doj">Philippine News Agency. (n.d.). *DOJ asked to indict Okada on USD10-M estafa cases*. Retrieved from https://www.pna.gov.ph/articles/1038479</ref> The Department of Justice subsequently ordered the National Bureau of Investigation to probe the circumstances surrounding the premature disclosure of the resolutions, with Justice Secretary Menardo Guevarra stating that "premature disclosure of orders and resolutions prior to official release is not allowed unless there are compelling reasons."<ref name="pna-doj-probe">Philippine News Agency. (n.d.). *DOJ to probe Parañaque fiscal handling estafa raps vs. Okada*. Retrieved from https://www.pna.gov.ph/articles/1036614</ref>

Notably, the DOJ ultimately affirmed the merits of Paudac's dismissals. In December 2018, the DOJ issued a resolution affirming the May 15, 2018 dismissal of the LED-supply estafa case, finding that TRLEI "failed to prove that there is conspiracy" among the respondents.<ref name="bworld">BusinessWorld. (January 20, 2019). *DoJ affirms dismissal of estafa case vs Okada, others*. Retrieved from https://www.bworldonline.com/editors-picks/2019/01/20/209827/doj-affirms-dismissal-of-estafa-case-vs-okada-others/</ref> The legal reasoning behind Paudac's resolutions, notwithstanding the procedural controversy, was thus upheld by the department.

The Okada Manila episode illustrates the kind of high-pressure environment that defined Paudac's leadership of the OCP-Parañaque: a jurisdiction where the city's role as home to major casino resorts and business interests frequently placed his office at the center of nationally consequential disputes.

Leadership and Institutional Stewardship

Beyond the high-profile cases, Atty. Paudac's sustained contribution to the OCP-Parañaque was organizational. He led an office responsible for one of the most demanding dockets in the NCR, with a team of assistant city prosecutors handling hundreds of cases across criminal categories. He was known for working within the "Pillars of Justice" framework that underpins the National Prosecution Service's philosophy of fairness, accountability, and due process.

The OCP-Parañaque under his leadership maintained the institutional pledge that defined its public posture:

> "We undertake to provide every person equal access to justice, to faithfully safeguard constitutional rights and to ensure that no one is deprived of due process of law."<ref name="docshare" />

Under Paudac's watch, the office served this mandate across the full spectrum of Parañaque's population, from the city's working-class barangays to its entertainment and commercial districts.

Achievements and Recognition

Emerald Pillar of Law Award

In December 2025, upon his retirement from government service, Atty. Paudac was honored with the **Emerald Pillar of Law Award** by the **Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), Lanao del Sur Chapter**. The award recognized his lifetime of dedication to the rule of law, his decades of service in the National Prosecution Service, and his role in anchoring the institutional credibility of the Parañaque prosecution office.<ref name="source-doc">Source document: *Atty. Amerhassan C. Paudac*. Biographical brief submitted for BangsamoroPedia. (2025). </ref>

The "Pillar of Law" recognition is among the IBP's most meaningful tributes, reserved for senior members of the bar who have demonstrated sustained fidelity to the ideals of the legal profession. That the recognition came from the IBP's Lanao del Sur Chapter, the chapter rooted in his Maranao homeland, carries particular significance: it was his own community acknowledging a son who carried their name with distinction into the highest offices of Metro Manila's justice system.

Recognition as a Trailblazer

Atty. Paudac's significance extends beyond his own record. By reaching the position of City Prosecutor in the NCR as a Muslim professional from Lanao del Sur, he became a visible example that the Bangsamoro community's capacity for professional excellence was not limited by geography. At a time when Muslim Mindanaoans in Metro Manila's legal institutions were few, his presence at the helm of the OCP-Parañaque carried a representational weight that went beyond his individual performance.

His career demonstrated that the values of the Maranao, rooted in a tradition that prizes both learning (*ilmu*) and honor (*maratabat*), translated powerfully into the demands of modern state institutions.

Personal Values and Cultural Significance

Atty. Paudac's public identity is inseparable from his faith and his ethnicity. As a practicing Muslim and a Maranao, he navigated a predominantly Christian institution, the Philippine legal system, without abandoning either his cultural grounding or his professional obligations. He is a living example of what Bangsamoro scholars and advocates often describe as the capacity of Muslim Filipinos to contribute to national institutions while remaining rooted in their own heritage.

His family's collective achievement reflects his personal conviction that education and integrity are not just individual virtues but communal ones. Six children in six different professional fields, all at senior levels, is not an accident of talent. It's the product of a household that treated learning as worship and service as obligation.

His children's careers also span the full arc of Bangsamoro professional aspiration: from Atty. Hasminah's work in international law and climate advocacy, to Atty. Mohammad Fayez's government legal service, to Princess Habibah Sarip-Paudac's pioneering presence as the first Filipina hijabi to appear as a news presenter on national television, <ref name="barmm">Bangsamoro Information Office. (March 30, 2024). *Breaking stereotypes as an empowered Bangsamoro hijabi*. Retrieved from https://bangsamoro.gov.ph/news/latest-news/breaking-stereotypes-as-an-empowered-bangsamoro-hijabi/</ref> the Paudac family's story is, in many ways, a microcosm of the Bangsamoro community's journey into the mainstream of Philippine professional life.

Legacy

Atty. Amerhassan C. Paudac Sr. leaves behind a record defined by longevity, institutional commitment, and cultural courage. For decades, he led one of Metro Manila's most active prosecution offices, navigating complex criminal litigation, high-profile controversies, and the daily demands of a system where justice can be slow and the pressures can be enormous.

His legacy is also familial and communal. The legal dynasty he and Norminah built is not just a point of family pride: it is a public argument, made in the form of six distinguished careers, for the capacity of the Maranao people and the broader Bangsamoro community to excel in every domain of Philippine society.

When the IBP-Lanao del Sur Chapter placed the Emerald Pillar of Law Award in his hands in December 2025, it was recognizing more than years of service. It was acknowledging a man who, for decades, quietly held up a portion of the edifice of Philippine justice, carrying the weight of his community's hopes alongside his docket.

He is, in the truest sense of the word, a pillar.

See Also

- National Prosecution Service (Philippines)
- Department of Justice (Philippines)
- Maranao people
- Bangsamoro
- Integrated Bar of the Philippines
- Parañaque City
- Okada Manila
- Philippine Bar Examinations

Further Reading

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